

Aanya Deshpande

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Communications lead with six years in-house across consumer health and fintech. Most of my work is earned media and the awkward weeks when a story is not the one we planned.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Communications Executive — Verdant Health India

Feb 2023 – present

- Ran the press response to a voluntary batch recall of a supplement line. Fielded 43 journalist calls in the first 72 hours, briefed the CEO before a live TV interview, and issued four holding statements. Coverage settled neutral-to-positive in 9 of 12 national outlets; no regulator correction was issued.
- Grew earned placements from 12 to 58 per quarter over 18 months by rebuilding the journalist list around eight beat reporters instead of a 400-name blast.
- Own the monthly coverage report: volume, share of voice against three competitors, message pull-through, and sentiment. Built it in Meltwater and rewrote the summary page so the exec team reads one page rather than forty.
- Wrote and placed a founder op-ed in Mint on supplement labelling rules; it was cited in two follow-up trade pieces.

Communications Executive — Kite Payments

Jul 2020 – Jan 2023

- Planned and delivered the launch communications for a UPI-linked credit product: embargoed briefings with 11 reporters, a launch-day Q&A; document, and a spokesperson prep session. 22 pieces of launch coverage.
- Handled a data-exposure story where a researcher went to the press before us. Drafted the statement with legal in under four hours and set up a call between the CTO and the reporter, which changed the framing of the published piece.
- Managed the agency relationship and the quarterly retainer scope, including cutting a workstream that produced volume but no target-outlet coverage.

TOOLS

Meltwater, Muck Rack, Google Analytics, Cision. Working knowledge of AP and Reuters style.

EDUCATION

MA Communication Studies, University of Pune, 2020